BitcoinTX CSV Import Guide

Overview

The CSV Import feature allows you to bulk-import your Bitcoin transaction history into BitcoinTX. This is useful for:

- Setting up a new installation with existing data
- Migrating from another tracking system
- Restoring from a CSV backup

Important: The database must be empty before importing. This ensures clean FIFO cost basis calculations. If you have existing transactions, delete them first from the Settings page.

Quick Start Guide

Step 1: Download the Template

Go to Settings → Data Management and click "Download Template". This gives you a CSV file with the correct column headers and sample rows.

Step 2: Fill in Your Data

Open the template in a spreadsheet application (Excel, Google Sheets, etc.) and replace the sample rows with your actual transaction data. Delete any sample rows you don't need.

Step 3: Preview the Import

Upload your CSV file and click "Preview". The system validates all rows and shows you any errors or warnings. Fix any issues before proceeding.

Step 4: Execute the Import

If the preview shows no errors, click "Import" to create all transactions. The import is atomic – if anything fails, no transactions are created.

Field Reference

CSV Columns

Column	Required	Description
date	Yes	Date/time (ISO8601 preferred). Without a timezone it is in your tax timezone (Settings); a date alone means noon
type	Yes	Transaction type: Deposit, Withdrawal, Transfer, Buy, Sell
amount	Yes	BTC (up to 8 decimals), or USD for Bank/Exchange USD rows. Transfer: what left the account, fee included. Withdrawal: what the recipient got, fee on top
from_account	Yes	Source account name
to_account	Yes	Destination account name
cost_basis_usd	Conditional	Buy: USD paid for the BTC, before the fee (the fee column is added to the basis). BTC Deposit: required (0 if unknown); Income/Interest/Reward/Rebate blank = that hour's value; Inherited: its value on the date of death, blank = that day's value
proceeds_usd	Conditional	Sell: gross USD, before the fee (the fee is subtracted). Spent withdrawal: value received, before the network fee (the fee's value is subtracted); blank = that hour's value
fee_amount	No	Fee amount (never also included in cost_basis_usd or proceeds_usd)
fee_currency	No	USD for Buy/Sell and moves out of Bank/Exchange USD; BTC for moves out of Wallet/Exchange BTC
source	No	For Deposits: N/A, MyBTC, Gift, Inherited, Income, Interest, Reward, Rebate
purpose	Conditional	A BTC withdrawal (from Wallet or Exchange BTC): Spent, Gift, Donation or Lost. From Bank or Exchange USD: any short text on one line, or blank
notes	No	Optional notes (not imported, for your reference only)
fee_usd	No	Transfer/Withdrawal with a BTC fee: what the fee was worth in USD. Blank = fee x that hour's BTC price
fmv_usd	No	Gift, Donation or Lost withdrawal: its fair market value when it left (shown in the tax report); blank = the BTC price when its hour began x the amount (that day's where there's no hourly price), or blank without a price
broker_reporting	No	Sell/Withdrawal: only when your broker's 1099-DA/1099-B differs: none, proceeds or basis. Blank = automatic
fee_usd_typed	No	With fee_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed that value, no if it came from the price (the export writes it)
cost_basis_typed	No	Income/Interest/Reward/Rebate/Inherited deposit with cost_basis_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed it, no if it came from the price (the export writes it)
acquired_at	Conditional	MyBTC or Gift deposit into Wallet/Exchange BTC: when the coins were first acquired (by the giver, for a gift); blank = the deposit's date. Inherited: the date of death (required)

proceeds_typed	No	Spent withdrawal with proceeds_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed them, no if they came from the price (the export writes it)
price_moment	No	With a value from the price: hour (the BTC price when its hour began, UTC) or day (that day's 00:00 UTC price). Blank = day (the export writes it)
fmv_typed	No	Gift/Donation/Lost withdrawal with fmv_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed it, no if it came from the price (the export writes it)

Settings > Export CSV writes these same columns, so an export imports back to the same ledger.

Transaction Types

Type	Description
Deposit	Money or BTC coming in from outside (BTC you held elsewhere, a gift received, income; dollars into Bank or Exchange USD)
Withdrawal	Money or BTC leaving (BTC spent, given, donated or lost; dollars out of Bank or Exchange USD)
Transfer	Moving money or BTC between your own accounts (not a sale; a BTC network fee is a small disposal). Wallet to Wallet: a consolidation, where only the fee is recorded
Buy	Purchasing BTC on an exchange with USD
Sell	Selling BTC on an exchange for USD

Account Names

Account	Description
Bank	Your fiat bank account (USD)
Wallet	Your self-custody Bitcoin wallet
Exchange USD	USD balance on an exchange
Exchange BTC	BTC balance on an exchange
External	Outside your portfolio (source for deposits, destination for withdrawals)

Source Values (for Deposits)

Value	Description
N/A	Not applicable or unspecified
MyBTC	BTC you already owned (transferring in)
Gift	Received as a gift (cost_basis_usd: the giver's basis, 0 if unknown)

Inherited	Inherited from someone who died: acquired_at is the date of death (required), cost_basis_usd its value that day (or on the estate's alternate valuation date; a Form 8971 value that increased the estate tax caps it); always long-term, INHERITED on Form 8949
Income	Payment for goods/services
Interest	Earned as interest
Reward	Mining, staking, or a sign-up or referral bonus (income)
Rebate	Bitcoin back for spending, such as a rewards card's sats-back (not income; its value is its cost basis)

Purpose Values (for BTC Withdrawals)

Value	Description
Spent	Used to purchase goods/services (taxable sale)
Gift	Given as a gift
Donation	Donated to charity
Lost	Lost or stolen BTC

Account Rules by Transaction Type

Each transaction type has specific account requirements. The system enforces these rules during validation.

Type	From Account	To Account	Required Fields
Deposit	External	Bank, Wallet, Exchange USD or Exchange BTC	Into Wallet or Exchange BTC: cost_basis_usd required (0 if unknown); Income/Interest/Reward/Rebate: blank = that hour's value; Inherited: acquired_at (date of death) required; blank = that day's value
Withdrawal	Bank, Wallet, Exchange USD or Exchange BTC	External	From Wallet or Exchange BTC: purpose required; proceeds_usd for "Spent"
Transfer	Any account	Another account, same currency; or the same Wallet or Exchange BTC	Fee in the sending account's currency; to the same account (a consolidation): a BTC fee is required, and only it is recorded
Buy	Bank or Exchange USD	Exchange BTC	cost_basis_usd required; fee must be USD
Sell	Exchange BTC	Exchange USD	proceeds_usd required; fee must be USD

Supported Date Formats

The following date formats are accepted. ISO8601 with timezone is recommended. A date or time without a timezone is read in your tax timezone (Settings), and a date alone means noon that day, so it stays in the right tax year:

Format	Example
ISO8601 with Z (preferred)	2024-01-15T10:30:00Z
ISO8601 with timezone	2024-01-15T10:30:00+00:00
ISO8601 without timezone	2024-01-15T10:30:00
Date with time	2024-01-15 10:30:00
Date only	2024-01-15
US format with time	01/15/2024 10:30:00
US format date only	01/15/2024

Example Rows

Below are example CSV rows for each transaction type. Use these as templates for your own data.

Buy from Exchange USD:

```
2024-01-15T10:30:00Z,Buy,0.012,Exchange USD,Exchange BTC,500.00,,5.00,USD,,,
```

Buy from Bank (auto-buy):

```
2024-01-20T08:00:00Z,Buy,0.05,Bank,Exchange BTC,2500.00,,10.00,USD,,,
```

Sell (selling BTC on exchange):

```
2024-02-15T11:30:00Z,Sell,0.3,Exchange BTC,Exchange USD,,15000.00,10.00,USD,,,
```

Deposit (BTC entering your wallet):

```
2024-01-20T14:00:00Z,Deposit,0.5,External,Wallet,21000.00,,,,Income,,
```

Withdrawal (spending BTC):

```
2024-03-01T09:00:00Z,Withdrawal,0.1,Wallet,External,,5500.00,,,,Spent,
```

Transfer (moving between wallets):

```
2024-02-01T16:45:00Z,Transfer,1.0,Exchange BTC,Wallet,,,0.0001,BTC,,,
```

Transfer within the wallet (a consolidation: only the fee):

```
2024-02-05T09:00:00Z,Transfer,0.4,Wallet,Wallet,,,0.00005,BTC,,,
```

Troubleshooting

Common Errors

Error	Solution
"Database has X existing transactions"	Delete all transactions from Settings before importing
"Invalid transaction type"	Use exactly: Deposit, Withdrawal, Transfer, Buy, or Sell
"Invalid account name"	Use exactly: Bank, Wallet, Exchange USD, Exchange BTC, or External
"cost_basis_usd required for Buy"	Add the USD paid for the BTC, before the fee
"proceeds_usd required for Sell"	Add the gross USD, before the fee

"A BTC withdrawal needs a purpose"	From Wallet or Exchange BTC, add purpose: Spent, Gift, Donation, or Lost
"Invalid accounts for Buy"	Buy must be: from Bank or Exchange USD, to Exchange BTC
"Invalid accounts for Sell"	Sell must be: from Exchange BTC, to Exchange USD
"Invalid accounts for Deposit"	Deposit must be: from External, to Bank, Wallet, Exchange USD or Exchange BTC
"Transfer must have different from_account and to_account"	Only Wallet or Exchange BTC can send to itself (a consolidation); Bank and Exchange USD can't
"A move within the same account records only its network fee"	A Wallet to Wallet (or Exchange BTC to Exchange BTC) transfer needs its fee_amount in BTC

Tip: Use the Preview feature to validate your CSV before importing. Fix all errors shown in red before clicking Import.